suffering eventually led to revolt and the Telangana armed struggle in the mid-20th century.[83] In the Great Indian Desert, also called the Thar Desert, in western Rajasthan, there was a similar outlawing of peripatetic groups in the 19th century to curtail mobility.[84] Another impact of colonization that reduced spatial mobility was the extensive demilitarization that took place in the 19th century such that the share of the military in the population fell from around 2 to 4 per cent during Akbar's reign to less than one-third of a percentage.

While some colonial policies were restricting mobility, others were increasing mobility in the late 18th and early 19th century. European ventures in gunpowder manufacture, indigo and opium involved factories and fields that used migrant labour and contributed to the goods traffic along the Ganga which employed as many as 3,50,000 boatmen by the 1830s.[85] The construction of canals and roads similarly led to the demand for migrant labour.[86] In places where harsh land taxes were levied, there was no option to play a cricket match and escape it, as depicted in the Bollywood blockbuster *Lagaan.* Migration was very much a strategy of resistance. Deindustrialization in the early 19th century due to cheap machine-made British cloth flooding Indian markets led to a realignment of textile manufacturing, triggering weaver migration from eastern Uttar Pradesh to upcoming centres like Bombay, Bhiwandi and Malegaon in western India.[87] The term 'Madanpura' or 'Mominpura' became a metaphor for Muslim Julaha weaver migrations as they settled in recreated Madanpuras of these three urban centres.[88] Internal barriers to trade were broken down in the 1830s and factories, plantations, ports and mines in India and outside began to beckon Indian labour and capital, centred around the colonial port cities of Calcutta, Bombay and Madras. The Crown rule took over administration of the country from the English East India Company after a revolt in 1857, and since then British India (including Burma since 1886) was more firmly entrenched in the global circulation of labour.

The introduction of the railways and steamboats played a decisive role in the next phase of modern migrations, increasing the speed of travel in the